Revocation mechanisms vary. Some issuers offer a real-time status endpoint, while others publish a signed revocation list that ACME can check locally. In either case, the authorization engine must verify that the credential has not been revoked before using its claims. Since ACME already trusts NISA's governance framework and the software implementing its revocation processes, it has confidence that the revocation information is accurate and can be used safely in high-assurance decisions.

These checks can have operational consequences. Suppose that Brian, another auditor at AuditsRUs, tries to access ACME's systems after his employment ends. His employment credential might still be cryptographically valid, but AuditsRUs would have revoked it. When Brian presents his credentials, ACME verifies their signatures, confirms their issuer, and then retrieves or validates their revocation status. Since Brian's credential is no longer valid, ACME automatically denies access. This process eliminates the need for manual deprovisioning and prevents outdated accounts from remaining in ACME's identity systems.

Verifiable credentials give ACME a scalable way to incorporate authoritative external context in authorization decisions without expanding its identity systems or creating fragile integrations. The trust store specifies which issuers ACME depends on and for which credential types, enabling ACME to reuse those trust decisions across many products and use cases. Freshness and revocation checks verify that the information from those issuers stays current, accurate, and safe to use. Collectively, these mechanisms allow ACME to make high-confidence, real-time authorization decisions based on data it does not maintain while reducing administrative overhead and enhancing the security of its overall process.

16.5 Requesting verifiable credential presentations

When ACME needs attributes from an external party, it does not request a specific credential. Instead, it requests the claims necessary to make a particular authorization decision. The holder responds by creating a credential presentation, which may include claims from one or more credentials. This indirection is important because it allows ACME to request